

SDN the control and data planes are decoupled, network intelligence and state are logically centralised and the underlying network infrastructure is abstracted from the applications. As a result, a network administrator gains unprecedented programmability, automation and network control, enabling him to build highly scalable, flexible networks that readily adapt to changing business needs.

OpenFlow-based SDN is currently being rolled out in a variety of networking devices and software, delivering substantial benefits to both enterprises and carriers, including:

1. Centralised management of networking equipment from multiple vendors
2. Improved automation so that network administrators deal just with the business policies and abstracting the underlying complication of provisioning individual components
3. Possibility of rapidly deploying newer services, without being blocked by any network device or a vendor to

release an update

4. Opening avenues for all parties to generate revenue by enabling programmability of the network through open API, creating vendor independence

5. Centralised and automated management to increase the reliability of the network and, because the network is flexible, enhancing the reliability by automatically reprogramming in the event of failure

6. Granular network control with the ability to apply comprehensive and wide-ranging policies at the session, user, device and application levels

7. Enhance end users' experience as the network adapts, the network is centralised and changes in the network appear seamless to the end-user

Conclusion

The strength of SDN lies in building a scalable and adaptable network which can be changed to adapt to the need of the environment. SDN banks on building the network with basic individual

components, all separated out but controlled in unison using powerful software.

The SDN technology is still shaping up and different vendors are implementing the solution to differentiate themselves from the others, along with a strong standardisation effort being made by various organisations. It is difficult for each of these vendors to ignore the standardisation, but they are free to build in hooks such that their solutions work better with their own components than with a competitor's components.

The main effect of the SDN will be seen by the service provider and the larger enterprises. The end users will experience the virtue of SDN in the form of enhanced services from the cloud, seamless usage of the network and security of their data. ●

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